Buncrana Parish Newsletter

ST. MARY'S HALL & CINEMA

Last weekend's collection totalled €5,010
We gratefully acknowledge a donation of €300 towards Parish Funds.
Sincere thanks.

Anniversary Masses & Times

ST MARY'S ORATORY
Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/buncrana
Monday 4 May - Mass at 10am
Tuesday 5 May - Mass at 10am
Special Intention
Wednesday 6 May - Mass at 10am
Thursday 7 May - Mass at 10am
Saturday 9 May - Mass at 4:30pm
Sheila Doherty (30th A),
Maggie McDaid (Roe), plus
Kathleen Doherty (Friel)
Sunday 10 May - Mass at 8:30am
Sunday 10 May - Mass at 12:30pm
Emmanuel Familola and Matt Sibanda (1st A)

ST. MARY'S, COCKHILL
Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/cockhill
Friday 8 May - Mass at 7pm
Agnes Cuffe (MM),
Vera McFadden (MM), plus
Alec Grant (1st A)
Sunday 10 May - Mass at 11am
Kathleen (Kate) Porter - Requiem Mass and Burial of Ashes

STAR OF THE SEA, DESERTEGNEY
Masses streamed on
www.youtube.com/@BuncranaParish
Sunday 10 May - Mass at 9:45am

DEATHS
Your prayers are asked for
Tommy McCarron
Francis Kerrigan
who died recently and for their families & friends saddened by their loss.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS
Our first reading tells the story of the selection of the first seven deacons. We pray for those recently, or soon to be, ordained to the Diaconate. Here in the Diocese of Derry we pray God's blessing on Deacon Stephen Baxter who will be ordained to the priesthood on 14 June, that the Lord will bless him in his future ministry.

ALL IRELAND ROSARY RALLY
A bus is being organised to Knock for the All-Ireland Rosary Rally on Sat 6 June.
Contact Mary on 0861268123 to book or for further information.

CHURCH GATE COLLECTION
There will be a Church Gate Collection in aid of funds for St Egney's NS at all Masses this weekend (2 and 3 May.)
There is also a fundraising Ceili on Friday 8 May in Desertegney Hall. All welcome.

DIVINE MERCY DEVOTIONS
will take place on Friday 8 May at 6.15pm in St. Mary's Church, Cockhill, followed by Mass at 7pm. **All Welcome**

Priest on Call 074 9361253

Email: buncranaparish@gmail.com
Website: www.buncranaparish.com
Fifth Sunday of Easter
3 May 2026

SACRAMENT OF CONFIRMATION 2026
We congratulate all of our young people from Scoil Íosagáin, St Oran's NS, St Egney's NS, Scoil Naomh Padráig, Scoil Naomh Iósaf, and Gaelscoil Bhun Crancha who received the Sacrament of Confirmation over the last two weeks. They were marvellous occasions for the parish and it was uplifting to see such joyful witnesses to the faith. Please continue to keep these young people in your prayers.

SAVE THE DATE
FATHER BRADLEY'S 30TH ANNIVERSARY 2026
Father Bradley marks thirty years as a priest this year. He was one of the three priests ordained in St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, in 1996. Particularly because it was not possible to celebrate his Silver Anniversary in 2021 when we were under Covid lockdown, the parishes will mark this moment on Sunday 28 June 2026 with Mass at 3pm in St Mary's Church, Cockhill, in the presence of Bishop McKeown, followed by a gathering in the Inishowen Gateway Hotel. All will be welcome. More details will follow.

READINGS FOR 5TH SUNDAY OF EASTER
First Reading: In every age the spirit inspires adaptations that are needed. The Apostles created the diaconate, to deal with a problem that had arisen in 'the daily distribution of food to widows. The Apostles, thus freed to continue the spread of the Gospel, succeeded in many conversions, including "a large group of priests."
Second Reading: We are precious stones, to be set close to Christ, the corner stone. Together we make a spiritual building. "We are….a royal priesthood…. a people set apart to sing the praises of God, who called you (us) out of darkness into his wonderful light."
Gospel: St Patrick would have loved this reading. "I am the Way, the Truth and the Life….if you know me, you know the Father too……..I am in the Father and the Father is in me……" Jesus was revealing the Blessed Trinity. St Patrick used the shamrock.

DONEGAL PRO LIFE
are inviting support to attend the March for Life in Dublin on Bank Holiday Mon 4th May. For details and to book the sponsored bus contact: Margaret on 089 2469599 or Teresa on 086 2647235 or Brian on 087 2913186.

KNOCK PILGRIMAGE TO PRAY FOR PEACE IN THE HOLY LAND
People from all over Ireland are invited to Knock Shrine on Sat 16 May, for a special pilgrimage to pray for peace in the Holy Land. The pilgrimage – organised by the papal charity Aid to the Church in Need – will be led by Bishop William Shomali from Bethlehem. Bishop Shomali will offer a message of hope at 11am, and celebrate Mass at 3pm. All are welcome.
More information at www.acnireland.org

BANK HOLIDAY
The Parish Office will be closed on Mon 4 May for the Bank Holiday and will re-open again on 5 May at 9am.

Fr Bradley 9363455
Fr Walsh 9361393
Fr Baker 9360151
Parish Office 9361253
Parish Catechist 086 785 3726

ADORATION CHAPEL
Please consider spending an hour in the Adoration Chapel
Sunday 2pm - 10pm
Monday - Wednesday 6am - 10pm
Friday 6am - 10pm

GUIDED HOLY HOUR
The Holy Hour in honour of the Holy Face of Jesus continues this Sunday at 6pm in St Mary's Oratory. All Welcome.

MAY ROSARY
The Rosary will be prayed at both the Oratory and Cockhill Grottos at 8pm each evening during the month of May. The Rosary will be offered for World Peace. Please come and join us during the month of May.

FATIMA STATUE
The Statue of Our Lady of Fatima is available for any person/family to have in their home for a week. Please contact Mary on 0860501418 to book or for further info.

ROSARY ON THE COAST
Sunday 3 May at 3pm at Lisfannon Beach. All welcome.

JOB OPPORTUNITY: DERRY DIOCESAN TRUST - Temporary Administrative & Financial Officer (15 Hours per week), parish of Urney & Castlefin, Co Donegal, based in the Parochial House in Doneyloop. Working Days & Times to be negotiated. Job Role: Reporting to the Parish Priest, the role entails provision of administrative and financial support. For application packs contact: Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP, telephone 028 7126 2302 or email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than **12 noon Thur 7th May 2026.**
DDT is an Equal Opportunities Employer.

THE LITTLE WAY NOVENA
in St Eugene's Cathedral 9 to 17 May: The theme is 'My peace consists in remaining little". The Novena will begin at the 7.30 pm Mass with the Sacrament of the Sick on Sat 9 May. Devotions and talk on Sun 10 May at 6pm. Mon to Fri (11 to 15 May) Novena Masses at 6.30 am and 10am each morning and an evening service with a guest speaker at 7.30 pm. Saturday 16 May 10am Mass for those who have died. The Novena will close on Sunday with blessing of the roses, 17 May at 3pm. Everyone is welcome to St Eugene's Cathedral for this time of prayer and petition.

PARISH DRAW

Friday 24 April: Week 46
1st Prize: €500
Jennifer Conway
Promoter: Marie Henderson
2nd Prize: €300
Raymond Gallagher, Elaghbeg
Promoter: Bernadette Gallagher
3rd Prize: €150
Kathleen Martin, Aghilly
Promoter: Mary McGonagle

KNOW YOUR EIRCODE – IT MATTERS On behalf of Buncrana First Responders: In our community, safety and coordination depend on clear communication. One of the simplest yet most important things you can do is make sure you know your Eircode. Your Eircode is essential for identifying your location quickly and accurately, especially in situations where time matters. Whether it's for routine coordination or an emergency, having your Eircode at your fingertips can make all the difference. Take a moment today to learn it, save it, and share it with those around you. A small step like this helps keep everyone informed, connected, and safe. **Stay aware. Stay prepared. Know your Eircode.**
BUNCRANA LIBRARY Click and Learn sessions will begin in the Buncrana library starting Thurs 30 April, 1.30 pm -3.30 pm. It will run for 4 weeks 30 April, 7, 14, and 21 May. Click and Learn is one to one sessions offering basic skills in using your smart phone, tablet or laptop for doing emails, WhatsApp, printing and social media. No booking necessary. If you require further info please ring 074 93 61941.
MEDJUGORJE PILGRIMAGES 2026 (45th Anniversary): 7 nights June 24th - July 1st. Depart Dublin - Mostar. Return Split - Dublin. €855 pp sharing. Single room supplement €170. For more information please contact Ursula O Faodhagain, Castlefin 0872960562
OMAGH CHARISMATIC PRAYER GROUP Mgr Barney McAleer, retired SMA priest, will give a Talk on ***'Our Lady, our Mother'*** on Thurs 7 May in the Pastoral centre, Brook Street, Omagh at 8pm. All are welcome.
BUNCRANA COMMUNITY LIBRARY as part of Bealtaine Festival 2026: ***Thur 7th May 11am*** Life Stories Writing Workshop with Isla McGuckin - Book online or call (074) 917 5384. ***Tue 12th May 11am*** The Swish of the Skirt & The Click of the Skivers - Book online or call (074) 917 5384. ***Fri 15th May 11.30am*** Hello, How Are You? Day - No need to book, just pop in. ***Tue 19th May*** Branching Out - Discover Your Family Story - Just Drop In
DAWN CHORUS WITH WILD INISHOWEN Join us for a gentle stroll around Swan Park to listen to and identify the singing birds, led by Martin Moloney. Meet at Castle Bridge on Sat 9 May at 5am.

BUNCRANA CINEMA See all show times www.thecinemabuncrana.com

Michael
12A | 130mins
Saturday 2nd May - 5pm & 8.15pm
Sunday 3rd - 5pm & 8.15pm
Monday 4th - Thursday 7th - 8.15pm

COMING NEXT WEEK
TRAD 8th - 14th May

BINGO

St Mary's Hall
Fridays at 8pm
Single book €11
Double €17
Snowball: €4300

Community Corner

SLIABH SNEACHT CENTRE **Drumfries Walking Group** (The Walkie Talkies) will be meeting on Fri 8 May at Dunree Beach car park at 10am everyone welcome. New 6 week **Fakeaway Cooking Class** beginning Wed 6 May from 7-9pm at a cost of €60pp, to book a place contact the centre on 0749361742.
THE CHILD BEHAVIOUR CONSULTANCY Is your child between 3-12 years of age and you need help with their behaviour? Contact Roisín Doherty - Behaviour Analyst at the Child Behaviour Consultancy to get advice regarding listening and following instruction, accepting 'No', and help with general behaviour. Contact 0894511432 to get a consultation set up.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS Amazing Grace Group, Buncrana have 5 meetings per week as follows: Sun 8pm, Tues 8pm, Thurs 11.30am, Fri 8pm & Sat 11.30am. If you think you may have a problem with alcohol, come along. Meeting in St Teresa's Room.
AL-ANON GROUP (for anyone whose life is or has been affected by someone else's drinking) meet in St Teresa's Room on Thurs at 6:45pm.
GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS weekly meeting in St Teresa's Room each Sun 5pm-6.30pm for anyone struggling with a gambling addiction.
GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS HELPLINE Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 048 7135 1329.
THE PLAZA *Mon* Beginners Line Dancing 7.30-8.30pm. *Tues* Morning Line Dancing at 10.30am. *Wed* Line Dancing Class at 7.30pm. *Thurs* **Line Dancing Class in Burt Hall** 7.45pm €7 per class. **Line Dancing and Jiving Class in Laurentic Bar** Thurs 7:30pm. Hall available for hire & for children's birthday parties. Contact Ursula on 0877538317
INISHOWEN MEDICAL Hearing loss? Earache? Blocked ears? It could just be wax. Inishowen Medical can help with that. We can offer both our patients and non-patients microsuction. Microsuction is a newer and more patient friendly way of clearing wax from ears. It is considered comfortable for the patient and can be used in every ear, even if there is a history of perforations. Get your hearing back today by calling Inishowen Medical to make an appointment on 074 93 61800 or 074 76173.
BEGINNER HATHA YOGA CLASS starting Monday 20th April at 7pm in Anglers Centre. Contact Anne Nelson 086 2586864 for more information.
DANCE FITNESS CLASS Every Tuesday 7-8pm in St Mary's Hall, Buncrana. All welcome to this full body workout to music.
FOUND A pair of glasses were found in the Oratory. Please contact the Parish Office to claim.
NOWDOC Phone Number: 0818400911
SAMARITANS Call Free **116 123,** Text **087 2609090.**
RACHEL'S VINEYARD Have you been affected or hurt by abortion? Please contact Michelle on 00447871765181

A THOUGHT...
You're never too important to be nice to people.

SLIMMING WORLD **Buncrana**: **The Exchange** every Tues 8am, 9.30am & 11am with Ann Marie 0860848705, 6pm with Marie 0877389059. **Carndonagh: The Colgan Hall** every Thurs at 6pm with Marie 0877389059. **Newtowncunningham: The Orange Hall** every Wed at 6.30pm with Ann Marie 0860848705. **Slimming World Buncrana are accepting donations of old clothes/shoes/ handbags in aid of Irish Cancer Society. Donations can be left every Tues until 5 May.**
GET THE GRADE English Tuition. Friendly, exam-focused, Junior & Leaving Cert tuition with experienced teacher of English & SEC Examiner (Teaching Council and Garda vetted). Text/Call Mark 0866655334
INISHOWEN INJURY CLINIC Treatment of back, neck and shoulder pain / sports injuries / rehabilitation. Contact Cahir McLaughlin NMT, Maginn Ave 0860753296
HEALTH & WELLBEING PARK RUN Come and join our community of walkers, runners and volunteers every Sat at 9.15am by the shore front play park. All welcome
GENTLE EXERCISE CLASS for people living with Parkinson's every Wed at 2pm in The Exchange.
COCKHILL CEILI CLUB Classes in Cockhill School Hall on Thurs from 8pm-9:30pm. Beginners welcome.
BUNCRANA PARENT AND TODDLERS GROUP in St Mary's Hall on Wed and Thur 10am-12noon.
SCOIL NAOMH IÓSAF **The Illies: F93 HX30 NOW ENROLLING for Sept 2026**. Forms are available on request by contacting the school: **Tel:** 9362212 **Email:** stjoesias@gmail.com
GAELSCOIL BHUN CRANNCHA Give us a call on 074 9361988 or an email at gsbc1999@gmail.com to discuss how an Irish medium education can benefit your child. If you don't speak Irish, don't worry. That won't hold your child back.
ANAM CARA is hosting a support evening for Bereaved Parents on Thurs 14 May in the Inishowen Gateway Hotel from 7:30pm-9pm.
INISHOWEN PALESTINE SUPPORT GROUP invites you to an Information Day on Sat 9 May in St Mary's Hall 12 - 6pm on becoming an ethical consumer. Includes film, refreshments, speakers. Concludes with a concert of local artists featuring The Henry Girls.
DOG FREE ZONE A reminder that dogs are not permitted in Cockhill or Desertegney graveyards. Thank you.
LOURDES 2026 Special Offer: Pilgrimage to Lourdes from 3rd until 8th July, 2026. Flights from Derry and full board £899. Contact Maria at 04881648357 or WhatsApp +44 7768395038

PRIVACY NOTICE: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A Privacy Notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting The Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St Mary's Oratory and St Mary's Cockhill are available online. Parishioners should note that the first two rows of seats are visible online in St Mary's Oratory and the first seven rows of seats are visible in St Mary's Cockhill.

SAFEGUARDING NOTICE: If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or **Garda Síochána,** Buncrana 074 9320540, Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or **TUSLA Family & Child Agency** 00353 749102233 **ROI Vetting Office: 074 93 63108**